

iQOO Z11 Lite

Battery champion on a budget

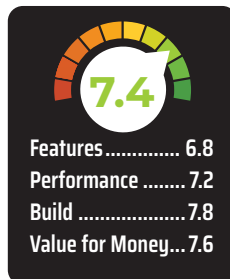
i QOO's Z Lite series has always been about hitting an affordable price point first and worrying about specs later. So, what really happened with the pricing this year? If you recall, the Z10 Lite launched around this same time last year for under Rs 10,000. The iQOO Z11 Lite, on the other hand, doubles that, and comes at a starting price of Rs 19,499 for the base 4GB RAM + 128GB storage variant. This is a significant increase of about Rs 9,500 from its predecessor. Of course, if you haven't guessed by now, the reason behind the insane price hike is the global chip shortage situation. Because the cost of components has increased exponentially, so have phone prices.

Looking at the bright side, compared to the older-gen model, the iQOO Z11 Lite brings a slightly faster processor, a bigger 6,500mAh battery with faster 44W charging, and Android 16. However, everything else, including the design, display, and cameras, remains largely unchanged. So before getting into how the iQOO Z11 Lite actually performs, the bigger question is: despite the ongoing situation, does the new model justify the significant price jump? Well, here's my take on it in this detailed review.

DESIGN AND BUILD

Design is really the only place iQOO has made a genuine change here, and it comes down to colour. The Z11 Lite ditches the T5 Lite's wave-pattern back for two new options instead: a moodier Midnight Blue, and a brighter Solar Flame for anyone who wants their phone to stand out.

₹19,499



iQOO sent us the Solar Flame colourway, which looks good and forms a distinctive pattern when the light hits it. Everything else about the build carries over almost identically. You still get a plastic back over a metal frame, and at 209 g and 8.39mm thick, the Z11 Lite weighs exactly the same as the T5 Lite. The side-mounted fingerprint scanner is back too, and it works fast and reliably. This budget device comes with an IP65 rating for dust and water resistance, so it will be safe to use during the monsoon.

In the iQOO Z11 Lite as well, you get a single top-firing speaker and head-phone jack, which is good and helpful for gamers who use 3.5mm headphones and charge the phone at the same time. If you liked how the T5 Lite felt in hand, you will feel right at home here, just with a different colour looking back at you. But for me, using the iQOO Z11 Lite

with one hand was not possible, and to reach the top corners I have to adjust my grip every single time.

DISPLAY

On paper, the display is identical to the T5 Lite: a 6.74-inch HD+ LCD panel with a 120Hz refresh rate and a water-drop notch that, frankly, still feels a generation behind in 2026. iQOO rates the panel at up to 1200 nits of peak brightness in HBM mode. However, we tested its display in our Digit Test Labs, and it got a peak brightness of 1040 nits. So sometimes in harsh sunlight you have to squint your eyes to use the display.

During my testing, I watched Squid Game Season 3 on Netflix along with a few scenes from Primal Fear. The panel doesn't deliver OLED-like blacks or that punch; I honestly found it decent for casual binge-watching. Colours look reasonably natural, skin tones don't appear over-saturated, and the 120Hz refresh rate makes scrolling through Netflix, Instagram and YouTube feel smoother. Viewing angles are okayish, although the display does lose some contrast when you watch from a tilted angle.

Interestingly, in our testing at Digit Test Labs, the T5 Lite returned a slightly different result. The Z11 Lite's Calman test gave an average delta E of 3.26, which is noticeably better than the T5 Lite's 4.22, and closer to what we would consider colour accurate, though colour gamut coverage came in at 94.43 per cent, which is slightly falling short of the T5 Lite's score.

Small unit-to-unit or calibration differences like this are not unusual on phones that share the same panel, and in day-to-day use, the viewing experience is close enough to the T5 Lite that we would not expect most people to tell the difference.

PERFORMANCE

Under the hood, it's the same MediaTek Dimensity 6300 5G chipset as the T5